Nyaya Saathi न्याय साथी

Problem 2, Build an AI Lawyer. Help for everyday legal problems in India, in plain English or Hindi, with real dates.

Gaurang Palekar · Roll No. 230104068 · Civil Engineering · Prototype: _____ (runs locally with **streamlit run app.py**, no API key)

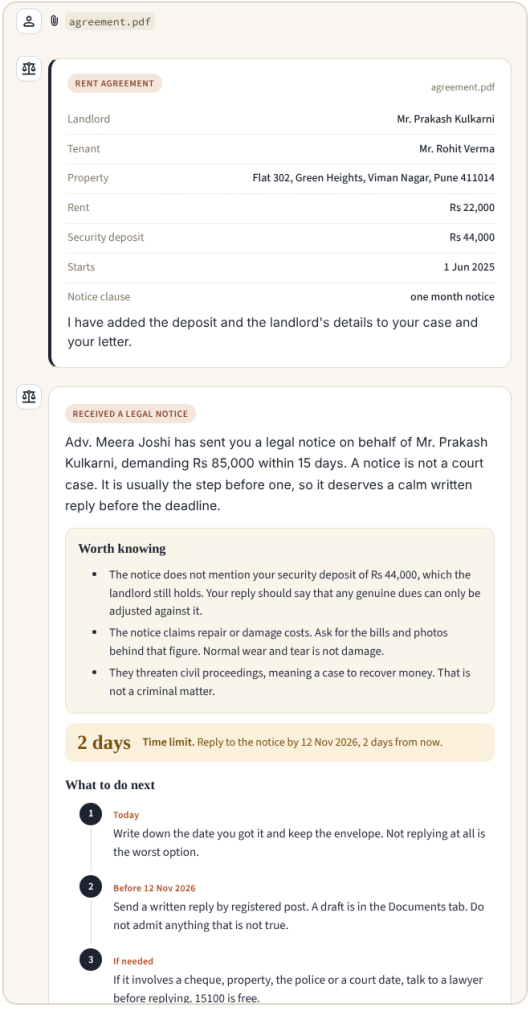
4	PDF · photo · Word	278 / 278	0
EVERYDAY PROBLEMS, IN DEPTH	NOTICES AND AGREEMENTS IT READS	CHECKS ACROSS 36 TEST CHATS	LAWS IT CAN INVENT

Who it is for

Someone whose landlord kept the deposit, or whose refund never came, usually does nothing: a lawyer feels expensive and the first step is unclear. I went deep on the four problems the brief names (a deposit, a refund, unpaid salary and a legal notice) and hand anything else, or anything risky, to a person. I picked it because a wrong date or an invented law costs a real person money, so it tests judgment as much as building. Central law applies; where state rules differ the app says so.

What it does

1. **Listens, then asks once.** Describe it however you talk. It picks out the amount, date, proof and city, understands *40k*, *2 mahine pehle* and *25000 रुपये*, and asks at most two short questions.
2. **Reads your papers.** Attach the notice you got, your rent agreement or a bill, as a PDF, Word file or phone photo, read offline. It shows what it found, explains it plainly and fills your case and letter. It also connects them: a notice claiming Rs 85,000 that never mentions your Rs 44,000 deposit gets flagged, and your reply says so.
3. **Tells you where you stand, with dates.** A plain answer, your last day to act (2 years for a consumer complaint, 3 for wages or a money suit, the notice's own deadline), three dated steps, a proof checklist and free help: NALSA 15100, 1915, e-Daakhil, SAMADHAN.
4. **Keeps talking.** Follow up questions (*can he cut painting charges?*) are answered from a checked FAQ. You can correct a number, open a second case, or get sent to 1930, 181 or 112 for fraud or violence.
5. **Drafts and rehearses.** A notice, a reply or a consumer complaint, prefilled and downloadable as Word. It then plays the other side and scores your answer.
6. **Easy to act on.** Every answer can be read aloud in English or Hindi, added to your phone calendar with reminders, shared on WhatsApp, or saved and reopened days later with the dates redone.



A photo of a notice, then the rent agreement. It reads both and spots what the notice leaves out.

How it avoids making up law

Everything legal it says comes from one file of 12 facts. Each fact has the statute and section, a plain explanation in English and Hindi, and a source note. I checked every one against the bare Acts and the government portals on 10 November 2026. Without a model, the app builds answers only from those facts, so it cannot invent anything. With a model connected, the model may only reword the opening summary, and a guard then scans every sentence for a *Section N* or an *Act, year*. Any sentence citing a law that isn't in the file is deleted before the user sees it. In testing I planted a fake *Section 420A of the Imaginary Consumer Rights Act* and the guard removed it while keeping the real Section 69. Dates and deadlines are always worked out in code, never by a model. Where the law itself is unsettled, the app says so instead of sounding sure, for example on the two-working-day final settlement rule under the Code on Wages.

When it says: get a real lawyer

Violence or a threat	Points to the police on 112 before anything else.
FIR, arrest, bail	Criminal matter. Points to a lawyer, free via 15100.
Court date or summons	Says missing it can hurt badly and to see an advocate now.
Bounced cheque notice	Warns about the 15 day window under Section 138.
Over Rs 50 lakh	Above the District Commission limit, so a lawyer is worth it.
Time limit passed	Says so, and that a lawyer should judge any delay.

How I tested it

I wrote 36 conversations of my own: Hindi, Hinglish, vague openers, skipped questions, every red flag, false alarm traps, the planted fake law, attached PDFs and photos, a pasted notice, a broken file, corrections, follow up questions, fraud and switching cases. All 278 checks pass, covering the problem, amounts, dates, deadlines, flags, language, what was read from each file, the prefilled letter and that every cited law exists. I also clicked through every button with a browser script. Transcripts and Word drafts are in **raw_outputs**.

These are cases I built against, so they show it works as designed, not that it handles every stranger's story.

Where it falls short

- It routes problems by keywords, so an unusual story can land on the wrong one. It asks when unsure.
- Photo reading drops a digit now and then (a PIN code read as 41104), so it tells you to check names and numbers.
- Offline it only answers questions in its FAQ, and says so for the rest. Hinglish gets English replies.
- Central law only, and it forgets everything when the tab closes.

Scale, cost and the human in the loop

Offline an answer costs nothing; reading a photo takes about two seconds on a laptop. With a model it is one short call per answer. The risk is the legal content, so that is where a human sits: a lawyer reviews every new fact and FAQ answer before it ships. A new problem, say an insurance claim, is new facts, questions, excuses and a letter template, with no code change. Logging where people give up shows what to add next.

Tools I used, and where AI got it wrong

I used Claude to help write the code and the first draft of the knowledge base, then verified each legal fact myself against official sources. A real slip from the build: the first version of the red-flag check matched the word *hit* inside *white*. Someone writing *the white walls were fine when I left* would have been told to call the police. It now matches whole words, and a test with that exact sentence keeps it fixed. A second one came from user testing: the fraud check fired on the word *UPI*, so *I have the UPI transfer receipt* was sent to the cyber crime helpline. It now needs a fraud word too, and that sentence is a test.